

175 Make a moth trap

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MINS

Moths are beautiful and fascinating insects, but because they come out mainly after sunset, they can be hard to see. Moths are attracted to light, so make a moth catcher and get a close look at these night creatures.

What you need

- White sheet • String
- 2 flashlights • Stapler
- Cardboard box • Scissors
- 4 egg cartons (no lids)
- Double-sided tape



1 Hang the sheet on a piece of string or drape it over a wall. Hang a flashlight behind it, or point it at the front of the sheet.



2 Open the top box flaps and cut off the two short ones. Cut one of these into four strips. Tape the egg cartons to the walls.



3 Staple the strips to the box top so the two flaps make a valley with a narrow slit about 1 in (3 cm) wide in the center.



4 At sunset, put the box by the sheet and switch on the flashlights. Place one in the box. After an hour, check the trap.

176 Is it a butterfly or a moth?

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Most moths come out at night; butterflies come out in the day. Moths spread their wings flat at rest; butterflies hold theirs upright.

